Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥5

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦5

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 7♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦J

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 6 3 ♥ K 10 7 ♦ A 9 4 ♣ Q 9 8 7	
♠ J 8 7 5 ♥ Q J 6 ♦ 8 2 ♣ A J 6 4	N W E S	♠ 10 9 2 ♥ 9 5 4 3 2 ♦ 6 5 ♣ 10 3 2
	♠ K Q 4 ♥ A 8 ♦ K Q J 10 7 3 ♣ K 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♥5

SOUTH not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners. So when NORTH jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, SOUTH uses Gerber.

NORTH shows two Aces so SOUTH decides 6NT will be just right.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul



	♠ 4 2 ♥ 5 2 ♦ K 10 9 4 3 2 ♣ 9 7 2	
♠ K Q 8 5 ♥ J 6 3 ♦ 8 7 ♣ A Q J 4		♠ A J 9 6 3 ♥ A 4 ♦ A Q J 6 ♣ K 5
	♠ 10 7 ♥ K Q 10 9 8 7 ♦ 5 ♣ 10 8 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♠[2]	Pass	5NT[3]	Pass
6♣[4]	Pass	6♠	

All Pass

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 0 kings

6♠ by East
Lead: ♦5

When WEST gives immediate ♠ support, EAST's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so EAST bids 4NT.

WEST's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which EAST cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

EAST bids 6♠ since WEST has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q J ♥ A K 10 ♦ K Q 2 ♣ K Q 7 3	
♠ 9 7 2 ♥ 3 2 ♦ 10 6 4 ♣ A 10 9 4 2		♠ 10 8 5 3 ♥ 6 5 ♦ A 7 5 ♣ J 8 6 5
	♠ A 6 4 ♥ Q J 9 8 7 4 ♦ J 9 8 3 ♣ —	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦4

NORTH expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but SOUTH gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

SOUTH then bids 3♠, showing first round control. NORTH tries 4NT (Blackwood) and SOUTH replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

NORTH bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ Q J 6 ♥ 9 2 ♦ J 5 ♣ K 8 7 5 4 2	
♠ K 5 ♥ A K 10 7 5 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ J 9 6	N W E S	♠ A 8 4 2 ♥ Q J 8 6 ♦ A 9 8 6 3 ♣ —
	♠ 10 9 7 3 ♥ 4 ♦ Q 10 4 2 ♣ A Q 10 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	5NT	Pass
7♥			
All Pass			

7♥ by West
Lead: ♦J

EAST's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

WEST bids 4NT, Blackwood.

EAST's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

WEST counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 5 3
♥ K Q J 10 3
♦ A
♣ K Q 10 6

♠ A J 9 8 6 4
♥ 8 6
♦ 10 7
♣ A 8 5



♠ Q 10 7 2
♥ 4 2
♦ Q J 5 3 2
♣ 7 4

♠ —
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ K 9 8 6 4
♣ J 9 3 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣7

NORTH figures that if SOUTH holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

SOUTH only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

NORTH manages to figure out that SOUTH has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.